

Solution Handout

Multi-Tenant Licensing, Onboarding & Access Control

Solution overview · CRM Platform · June 2026

1. What this solution does

When a new customer is signed, the platform lets the provider (super admin) license exactly the modules and feature-areas that were agreed — nothing more — and provision the customer's administrator in a single step. From there, the customer's own administrator manages their team's access within that licensed boundary. The boundary is enforced automatically across the menus, the role-builder, and the server APIs.

Design principle: the provider sells the package; the customer organises their people inside it; the software keeps everyone inside the lines.

2. The two layers (and why)

	Entitlement layer	Permission layer
Owner	Super admin (provider)	Tenant admin (customer)
Decides	Which modules & features are licensed	Who may view/create/edit/delete
Analogy (Salesforce)	Licenses / Editions	Profiles / Permission Sets
Changes when	Commercial agreement changes	Team structure changes

The entitlement is the ceiling. A role can only grant an action on a feature the customer actually licensed — exactly how enterprise CRMs prevent access to products an org never bought.

3. Onboarding flow

Step 1 — Workspace & admin details

- Company name, slug, plan, and the customer admin's name + email.
- Admin password: auto-generated temporary password (revealed once) or set manually.

Step 2 — Licensed modules & features

- A module → feature-area tree driven by a central catalog; tick only what was agreed.
- Core CRM is always on; the catalog is extensible — new modules appear here automatically.

On creation (automatic)

- The workspace is created with the exact entitlement recorded.
- The tenant admin login is provisioned and can sign in immediately.
- The four standard roles (Admin, Manager, Agent, Viewer) are seeded with sensible defaults — the super admin never configures role permissions.

4. How the boundary is enforced

Three independent checkpoints guarantee a customer can never reach something they didn't buy:

Checkpoint	Where	Effect
Roles screen	Tenant admin role-builder	Only licensed features are offered as create/edit/delete toggles.
Sidebar / menus	Every signed-in user	Unlicensed feature-areas are hidden from navigation.
API server	Every request	Calls to unlicensed features are rejected (403 NOT_LICENSED); calls beyond a user's granted action are rejected (403 FORBIDDEN).

Backward compatible: existing workspaces that pre-date entitlements are treated as fully licensed, so nothing breaks during rollout.

5. Credential handling

- On creation, an auto-generated temporary password is shown once and flagged for the provider to share securely.
- The customer admin signs in immediately and is expected to change it on first login.

Planned next: email the temporary password to the customer directly on creation, and provide a regenerate / reset flow for lost or rotated credentials.

6. Extensibility

Everything keys off one central catalog. To offer a brand-new module to customers, the engineering team adds it (with its feature-areas) to the catalog; it then flows automatically into the onboarding selection, the entitlement records, the Roles screen, the menus, and the enforcement layer — with no rework of the surrounding screens.

7. Current status

Capability	Status
License modules + features at onboarding	Delivered
Provision tenant admin + one-time password	Delivered
Auto-seed standard roles	Delivered
Roles screen limited to licensed features	Delivered
Sidebar hides unlicensed features	Delivered
API rejects unlicensed / unauthorised calls	Delivered
Email temp password + reset/regenerate	Planned (next)